



The multiple ways an engine figures out what you like

60% of their rentals are thanks to the recommendations given by Cinematch. Adding a social aspect helps tremendously, people tend to value the opinions of people they know and trust. This is one of the reasons why things go viral on social networks. Tapping the power of a social network becomes a huge driving factor.

Make your own recommender system

While you can find recommender systems available in the form of plugins, they are restricted to allow tags that suit their filters. This adds a little restriction to the system and will most probably affect your sales. So it is best to create your own recommender system for your website which is customised for the environment. There are plenty of open source recommender projects or libraries which can be used to create your own system and here are a few that should help you get started.

LensKit

It is a framework for creating a collaborative filtering recommender system. It also provides the infrastructure for you to compare your recommender system with others that have used the same algorithm. <http://dgit.in/Lenskit>

Crab

Another framework that enables user and item-based collaborative filtering. It's based on Python and integrates seamlessly with popular scientific python libraries. <http://dgit.in/CrabRecommend>

MyMediaLite

This is a library consisting of multiple algorithms which you can use to generate a recommender system and implements rating prediction based on collaborative filtering. <http://dgit.in/MyMediaLite>

Recommenderlab

This is an testing environment that allows you to prototype and test your system. It provides feedback in the form of accuracy of each recommendations. <http://dgit.in/RecommenderLab>

Neo4j

Primarily a graph database, Neo4j is helpful for new users to get familiar with the functioning of a recommendation engine. You can view each query executed as a graph. Here is a demonstration video wherein Neo4j is used to create a recommendation engine. <http://dgit.in/Neo4jDemo>



Neo4j graph database in action

*the source code



GaussianFace

>>>Computer scientists from the Chinese University of Hong Kong have developed GaussianFace, a facial recognition software that finally outperforms humans. Humans have an efficiency of 97.53 percent and this software boasts of an efficiency of 98.52 percent.

<http://dgit.in/GauFac>



Cryptol

>>>Cryptol is a domain-specific language for representing cryptographic algorithms. An implementation done using Cryptol is more similar to its mathematical representation than an implementation done using any general purpose language.

<http://dgit.in/Cryptol>



Netflix Roulette

>>>Netflix has made its Roulette API open so you no longer need any keys to query the API. Now you can get all sorts of information that Netflix stores about individual movies and series using a simple query and build your own website using the same.

<http://dgit.in/NetflixRoulette>